

Day 34 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: State Executive and State Legislature

READING MATERIAL

Covers the Governor (State Executive head), the Chief Minister and Council of Ministers (real executive authority), and the State Legislature's presiding officers (Speaker/Deputy Speaker of the Assembly, Chairman/Deputy Chairman of the Council). Real exam evidence shows precise traps about who appoints/receives resignations from whom, and exact Article numbers for presiding-officer provisions.

Q: How is the Governor appointed, what are the qualifications, and what is the normal term?

A: Appointed by the PRESIDENT (Article 155) by warrant under hand and seal — making the Governor effectively a nominee of the Central Government. Qualifications (Article 157): must be a citizen of India and at least 35 years of age (only two requirements). Normal term: 5 years, but holds office at the PRESIDENT's pleasure (Article 156) — can be removed/transferred before term's end. One person CAN be appointed Governor of two or more states simultaneously.

Q: What are the conditions of the Governor's office under Article 158?

A: The Governor must NOT be a member of either House of Parliament or of any State Legislature (must vacate such a seat upon appointment), and must NOT hold any other office of profit. The Governor is entitled to use of the official residence (Raj Bhavan) rent-free, and emoluments/allowances that cannot be reduced during the term.

Q: Real exam: To whom does a resigning member of the State Cabinet (a Minister) submit their resignation letter?

A: To the GOVERNOR — not to the Chief Minister, not to the Speaker, and not to their political party's President. (Ministers are formally appointed BY the Governor, so resignation is also submitted to the Governor, even though by convention they typically inform the CM as well.)

Q: Real exam: Under which Article does the Governor have ordinance-making power, and what does this power allow?

A: Article 213 — allows the Governor to promulgate Ordinances (having the force of law) when the State Legislature is not in session and the Governor is satisfied that immediate action is necessary.

Q: Real exam: Which statements about the appointment of a State's Chief Minister are TRUE — appointed by the President; a non-MLA may be appointed CM; other Ministers appointed by the Governor on the CM's advice?

A: TWO of the three are true: a person who is NOT currently a member of the State Legislature MAY be appointed Chief Minister (though they must then get elected to the Legislature within 6 months, per established constitutional convention); and other Ministers ARE appointed by the Governor on the advice of the Chief Minister (Article 164(1)). The FALSE part: the Chief Minister is appointed by the GOVERNOR, not the President.

Q: Real exam (Assertion-Reason): Why does the Chief Minister hold office 'during the pleasure of the Governor', and is this a genuine explanation?

A: Both statements are TRUE, and the Reason correctly EXPLAINS the Assertion: the Chief Minister holds office at the Governor's pleasure precisely BECAUSE the Chief Minister is appointed by the Governor (Article 164(1)) — though in practice, 'pleasure' is a formality; real continuance in office depends on retaining the confidence/majority support of the Legislative Assembly, not the Governor's personal discretion.

Q: What does Article 163 establish regarding the Governor's Council of Ministers?

A: There shall be a Council of Ministers headed by the Chief Minister to AID AND ADVISE the Governor in the exercise of their functions — EXCEPT in matters where the Governor is required by the Constitution to act in their own DISCRETION (a distinguishing feature from the President, who has no comparable general discretionary power).

Q: Real exam: Match Articles 178, 180, 182, and 184 to their correct provisions about the Assembly's and Council's presiding officers.

A: Article 178: establishes the Speaker and Deputy Speaker of the Legislative Assembly. Article 180: the POWER of the Deputy Speaker (or other person) to perform the duties of the Speaker's office. Article 182: establishes the Chairman and Deputy Chairman of the Legislative Council. Article 184: the POWER of the Deputy Chairman to perform the duties of the Chairman's office — confirmed via a real exam's match-the-following question.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Governor of a State is appointed by:

A. The Prime Minister

B. The Chief Minister

C. The President ✓

D. The Chief Justice of the High Court

Explanation: The President (Article 155). [easy, web-research]

2. What are the qualifications required to be appointed Governor of a State, per Article 157?

A. Citizen of India and at least 25 years of age

B. Citizen of India and at least 35 years of age ✓

C. Must have served as a Minister

D. Must be a member of the State Legislature

Explanation: Citizen of India, 35+ years of age. [medium, web-research]

3. Real exam: A member of the Tamil Nadu Cabinet wishing to resign their Ministerial post should submit the resignation letter to:

A. The Chief Minister

B. The Governor ✓

C. The Speaker of the Legislative Assembly

D. The President of their political party

Explanation: The Governor. [hard, question-bank-2026]

4. The Governor's power to promulgate Ordinances when the State Legislature is not in session is given under:

A. Article 123

B. Article 163

C. Article 164

D. Article 213 ✓

Explanation: Article 213. [medium, question-bank-2026]

5. Which of the following statements about the Chief Minister's appointment is TRUE?

A. The Chief Minister is appointed by the President

B. A person who is not a member of the State Legislature can never be appointed Chief Minister

C. Other Ministers are appointed by the Governor on the advice of the Chief Minister ✓

D. The Chief Minister is elected directly by the State's voters

Explanation: Other Ministers are appointed by the Governor on the CM's advice (Article 164(1)). [hard, question-bank-2026]

6. Assertion [A]: The Chief Minister holds office during the pleasure of the Governor. Reason [R]: The Chief Minister is appointed by the Governor. Choose the correct option.

A. [A] is true, [R] is false

B. [A] is false, [R] is true

C. Both [A] and [R] are true, and [R] is the correct explanation of [A] ✓

D. Both [A] and [R] are true, but [R] does not explain [A]

Explanation: Both true, and [R] correctly explains [A]. [hard, question-bank-2026]

7. The Council of Ministers, headed by the Chief Minister, exists to aid and advise the Governor — except when the Governor is required to act in:

A. Consultation with the President

B. Their own discretion ✓

C. Consultation with the Chief Justice

D. Accordance with the Speaker's direction

Explanation: Their own discretion. [medium, authored]

8. Article 178 of the Constitution establishes:

A. The Governor's discretionary powers

B. The Speaker and Deputy Speaker of the Legislative Assembly ✓

C. The Chairman and Deputy Chairman of the Legislative Council

D. The Governor's ordinance-making power

Explanation: Speaker and Deputy Speaker of the Legislative Assembly. [medium, question-bank-2026]

9. Which Article gives the Deputy Chairman of the Legislative Council the power to perform the duties of the Chairman's office?

A. Article 178

B. Article 180

C. Article 182

D. Article 184 ✓

Explanation: Article 184. [hard, question-bank-2026]

10. Can one person be appointed Governor of two or more States simultaneously?

A. No, never

B. Yes, this is constitutionally permitted ✓

C. Only during a National Emergency

D. Only with Supreme Court approval

Explanation: Yes — constitutionally permitted. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Percentage

READING MATERIAL

Percentage is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. TNPSC's percentage questions are built from a handful of recurring shapes — successive discounts, reverse percentage ('20% of $x = 50$, find x '), percentage of a mixture, and percentage of a time period — recognize the shape first, then compute.

Q: Method — successive percentage discounts: A TV was sold for ₹14,400 after successive discounts of 10% and 20%. What was its original (market) price?

A: Successive discounts don't add (it's NOT a flat 30% off) — apply them one after another. If the market price is P : $P \times 0.90 \times 0.80 = 14,400 \rightarrow P \times 0.72 = 14,400 \rightarrow P = 14,400 / 0.72 = ₹20,000$.

Q: Method — percentage of a mixture (the parts must add to 100%): An alloy is 30% copper and 40% zinc, rest nickel. Find the nickel in 20 kg of the alloy.

A: Nickel % = $100 - 30 - 40 = 30\%$. Nickel amount = 30% of 20 kg = 6 kg. The key step is realizing the percentages must total 100% — nickel is whatever's left over, not a number given directly.

Q: Method — reverse percentage ('find the whole, given a percentage of it'): If 20% of $x = 50$, find x .

A: 20% of $x = 50 \rightarrow 0.20 \times x = 50 \rightarrow x = 50 / 0.20 = 250$. Reverse-percentage questions give you the part and the percentage, and ask for the whole — divide, don't multiply.

Q: Method — percentage of a decimal/small number: Find 0.75% of 40 kg.

A: $0.75\% = 0.0075$. $0.0075 \times 40 = 0.3$ kg. Common mistake: treating '0.75%' as '0.75' (i.e. 75%) instead of converting the decimal percentage properly — always convert to a decimal fraction first (divide by 100) before multiplying.

Q: Method — percentage of a time period: What percentage of a day is 10 hours?

A: A day = 24 hours. $10/24 \times 100 = 41.67\%$.

Q: Method — percentage of a fraction: What percent of $2/7$ is $1/35$?

A: Set up: $x\% \text{ of } (2/7) = 1/35 \rightarrow x/100 \times 2/7 = 1/35 \rightarrow x = (1/35) \times (7/2) \times 100 = (7/70) \times 100 = 10\%$.

Q: Method — sum of two independent percentage-of-number terms: Find the value of 28% of 450 + 45% of 280.

A: 28% of 450 = 126. 45% of 280 = 126. Sum = $126 + 126 = 252$. (A nice coincidence both terms equal 126 here — don't expect that in general, just add the two percentage values separately.)

Q: Method — percentage greater than 100% (the result is bigger than the original number): Find 280% of 3,940.

A: $280\% = 2.80$. $2.80 \times 3,940 = 11,032$. Percentages over 100% just mean the result is larger than the base number — the calculation method doesn't change.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. A mobile phone was sold for ₹10,200 after successive discounts of 15% and 20%. What was its original price?

- A. ₹14,500
- B. ₹15,000 ✓**
- C. ₹15,500
- D. ₹16,000

Explanation: $P \times 0.85 \times 0.80 = 10,200 \rightarrow P \times 0.68 = 10,200 \rightarrow P = 15,000$. [medium, authored]

2. An alloy is 25% tin and 35% lead, the rest is copper. Find the copper in 40 kg of the alloy.

- A. 10 kg
- B. 14 kg
- C. 16 kg ✓**
- D. 20 kg

Explanation: Copper % = $100 - 25 - 35 = 40\%$. 40% of 40 kg = 16 kg. [easy, authored]

3. If 35% of $y = 91$, find y .

- A. 230
- B. 250
- C. 260 ✓**

D. 240

Explanation: $y = 91 / 0.35 = 260$. [easy, authored]

4. Find 1.25% of 80 kg.

A. 1 kg ✓

B. 10 kg

C. 0.1 kg

D. 12.5 kg

Explanation: $1.25\% = 0.0125$. $0.0125 \times 80 = 1$ kg. [easy, authored]

5. What percentage of a day is 6 hours?

A. 20%

B. 25% ✓

C. 30%

D. 16.67%

Explanation: $6/24 \times 100 = 25\%$. [easy, authored]

6. What percent of $3/8$ is $3/40$?

A. 10%

B. 15%

C. 20% ✓

D. 12%

Explanation: $x\%$ of $(3/8) = 3/40$, so $x/100 = (3/40) \div (3/8) = (3/40) \times (8/3) = 1/5$, giving $x = 20\%$. [medium, authored]

7. Find the value of 32% of 350 + 18% of 200.

A. 148 ✓

B. 138

C. 150

D. 146

Explanation: 32% of 350 = 112. 18% of 200 = 36. Sum = 148. [medium, authored]

8. Find 320% of 2,500.

A. 7,500

B. 8,000 ✓

C. 8,500

D. 9,000

Explanation: $320\% = 3.2$. $3.2 \times 2,500 = 8,000$. [easy, authored]

9. A quantity is first increased by 20%, then decreased by 20%. What is the net percentage change?

A. No change

B. 4% decrease ✓

C. 4% increase

D. 20% decrease

Explanation: Net change after +20% then -20% is always a decrease of $(20 \times 20)/100 = 4\%$ — increasing and then decreasing by the same percentage never cancels out, because the second change applies to a different (larger) base. [hard, authored]

10. The price of an item increases from ₹250 to ₹300. What is the percentage increase?

A. 15%

B. 20% ✓

C. 25%

D. 30%

Explanation: Increase = 50. Percentage increase = $(50/250) \times 100 = 20\%$. [easy, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "The Dying Detective" — Arthur Conan Doyle

READING MATERIAL

A Sherlock Holmes mystery in which Holmes fakes a deadly illness to trick a murderer, Culverton Smith, into confessing — revealing that the 'dying detective' was never really dying at all.

Q: Who wrote "The Dying Detective", and what is his full name and nationality?

A: Sir Arthur Ignatius Conan Doyle — confirmed as a BRITISH writer by a real exam question.

Q: Real exam: Who inspired Arthur Conan Doyle to create the character of Sherlock Holmes?

A: Joseph Bell — confirmed by a real exam question (Bell was a professor known for his exceptional observation and deduction skills, which influenced Holmes's detective method).

Q: What is the basic plot set-up — why is Holmes apparently dying, and who does he insist on calling instead of a real doctor?

A: Holmes has been seriously ill for 3 days. His housekeeper, Mrs. Hudson, is worried and wants to bring in a doctor, but Holmes refuses any doctor except Dr. Watson, whom he eventually asks her to call.

Q: Who is Culverton Smith, and what is his connection to the murder victim, Victor Savage?

A: Culverton Smith is a planter who lived in Sumatra and has specialized knowledge of the rare disease Holmes appears to be suffering from. He is the man who murdered Victor Savage (his own nephew) using this disease, and is eventually arrested by Inspector Morton on that charge.

Q: Real exam: What does Watson see when he returns to Holmes's room with Mrs. Hudson at the story's resolution?

A: Holmes was sitting up in bed — revealing that Holmes had never really been dying at all; the entire illness was a calculated ruse to trick Culverton Smith into revealing/confessing his guilt.

Q: Real exam: Where is the story/play's setting?

A: Sherlock Holmes's own bedroom (in his lodgings) — confirmed by a real exam question, ruling out Victor Savage's house, a New York apartment, or Dr. Watson's house as the setting.

Q: What object does Watson notice near the mantelpiece, relevant to the disease/murder weapon?

A: A small black-and-white ivory box — connected to how the deadly disease/infection was actually transmitted to victims.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The Dying Detective" was written by:

A. Mark Twain

B. Arthur Conan Doyle ✓

C. Ruskin Bond

D. Munshi Premchand

Explanation: Arthur Conan Doyle. [easy, question-bank-2022]

2. Sir Arthur Ignatius Conan Doyle was a ____ writer.

A. Irish

B. American

C. British ✓

D. French

Explanation: British. [medium, question-bank-2024]

3. Who inspired Arthur Conan Doyle to create the character of Sherlock Holmes?

A. Dr. Watson

B. Dr. Ainstree

C. Inspector Smith

D. Joseph Bell ✓

Explanation: Joseph Bell. [hard, question-bank-2025]

4. Whom does Holmes insist on calling, refusing all other doctors, while apparently dying?

A. Mrs. Hudson

B. Inspector Morton

C. Dr. Watson ✓

D. Culverton Smith

Explanation: Dr. Watson. [easy, web-research]

5. Culverton Smith, in the story, is revealed to be:

A. Holmes's old friend

B. A doctor treating Holmes

C. The murderer of Victor Savage ✓

D. A police inspector

Explanation: The murderer of Victor Savage. [medium, web-research]

6. When Watson returns to Holmes's room with Mrs. Hudson near the story's end, what does he see?

A. Holmes had died

B. Culverton Smith had escaped

C. Holmes was sitting up in bed ✓

D. Inspector Morton was already there

Explanation: Holmes was sitting up in bed — the illness was a ruse. [hard, question-bank-2022]

7. The setting of "The Dying Detective" is in:

A. Victor Savage's house

B. A New York city apartment

C. Dr. Watson's house

D. Sherlock Holmes's bedroom ✓

Explanation: Sherlock Holmes's bedroom. [medium, question-bank-2024]

8. Who eventually arrests Culverton Smith for the murder of Victor Savage?

A. Dr. Watson

B. Mrs. Hudson

C. Inspector Morton ✓

D. Holmes himself

Explanation: Inspector Morton. [medium, web-research]